



Everyday English Grammar Guide

by Granny, with love

The mistakes Hindi speakers make most, and the simple way
to fix them. No jargon, just what to say.

A free gift for Spoken English Granny Plus Lifetime members

Namaste, beta!

Everyday English Grammar Guide · Spoken English Granny · For Plus Lifetime members

This little guide is not a grammar textbook. It is a list of the small things that trip up almost every Hindi speaker, explained the way a grandmother would explain them: simply, kindly and with an example.

How to use it: read one section a day. Say every **right** sentence out loud three times. Then practise with Granny in the app and see if the red pen catches you!

Mistakes are not bad. Every mistake Granny circles is one step closer to speaking English with confidence.

What's inside

1. 16 mistakes we hear every day
2. Past, present and future made simple
3. a, an and the
4. in, on and at
5. Asking questions the right way
6. 45 irregular action words (go → went → gone)
7. Ready-to-use phrases for real life
8. Granny's 7 speaking habits

1. Sixteen mistakes we hear every day

Everyday English Grammar Guide · Spoken English Granny · For Plus Lifetime members

Instead of	Say	Why
I am having a car.	I have a car.	For things you own, just say 'have'. 'Am having' is only for things happening now, like 'I am having lunch'.
Myself Priya.	I am Priya. / My name is Priya.	'Myself' can't start a sentence on its own.
I am knowing him since 2 years.	I have known him for 2 years.	'Know' doesn't take '-ing'. Use 'for' with an amount of time, 'since' with a starting point (since 2022).
He don't like tea.	He doesn't like tea.	He / she / it → does / doesn't.
One of my friend is a doctor.	One of my friends is a doctor.	'One of' is always followed by many (friends).
We discussed about the plan.	We discussed the plan.	'Discuss' already means 'talk about'. No 'about'.
Please revert back.	Please reply. / Please get back to me.	'Revert' means go back to an old state. 'Back' is extra anyway.
I did not went there.	I did not go there.	After 'did / did not', always use the base word: go, eat, see.
She is my cousin sister.	She is my cousin.	In English, 'cousin' is for both boys and girls.
What is your good name?	What is your name? / May I know your name?	'Good name' is a word-for-word translation of 'shubh naam'.
I have done my graduation in 2020.	I graduated in 2020.	With a finished time (in 2020, yesterday), use the simple past.
Can you tell me where is the station?	Can you tell me where the station is?	Inside a bigger question, keep normal order: where the station is.
He is more taller than me.	He is taller than me.	'Taller' already means 'more tall'.
I will call you after reaching home.	I will call you when I reach home.	Sounds more natural in everyday English.
Do the needful.	Please do what is needed. / Please take care of it.	Common in Indian offices, but sounds old-fashioned to others.
Return back / repeat again	Return / repeat	'Return' and 'repeat' already include 'back' and 'again'.

2. Past, present and future made simple

Everyday English Grammar Guide · Spoken English Granny · For Plus Lifetime members

Look for the **time words**. They tell you which form to use.

When?	Time words	Pattern	Example
Every day / always	every day, usually, always, often	I work · she works	She goes to office every day.
Right now	now, right now, at the moment	am / is / are + -ing	I am cooking right now.
Finished in the past	yesterday, last week, in 2020, ago	past form (went, ate, played)	We went to Jaipur last year.
Past until now	since, for, already, just, ever	have / has + done form	I have lived here for five years.
Future	tomorrow, next week, soon	will + base word / going to	I will call you tomorrow.

Granny's trick: if you say *yesterday*, your action word must "wear old clothes": go → went, eat → ate, buy → bought.

Negatives and "did"

After **did** / **didn't** / **does** / **doesn't** / **will** / **can**, use the plain base word.

~~She didn't came.~~ → **She didn't come.** ~~He doesn't likes it.~~ → **He doesn't like it.**

3. a, an and the

Use	When	Example
a	one thing, first time you mention it, before a consonant <i>sound</i>	I bought a phone.
an	same, but before a vowel <i>sound</i> (a, e, i, o, u sound)	an apple, an hour, an MBA
the	a specific thing we both know, or only one exists	The phone I bought is great. The sun.
nothing	general ideas, most names, languages, meals	I love music. I speak Hindi. Let's have lunch.

4. in, on and at

Everyday English Grammar Guide · Spoken English Granny · For Plus Lifetime members

	Time	Place
in (big)	in May, in 2025, in the morning, in summer	in India, in Delhi, in the kitchen, in a car
on (medium)	on Monday, on 15 August, on my birthday	on the table, on the bus, on the second floor
at (exact point)	at 7 pm, at night, at the weekend	at home, at the station, at the door

Remember: *in* the car but *on* the bus / train / plane (you can stand up and walk in them!).

5. Asking questions the right way

In questions, the helper word comes **before** the person.

Instead of	Say
You are coming?	Are you coming?
Where you went yesterday?	Where did you go yesterday?
Why she is angry?	Why is she angry?
What you want?	What do you want?

Polite questions: **Could you ...?** · **Would you mind ...ing?** · **May I ...?**

Example: **Could you send me the file, please?** sounds friendlier than "Send me the file."

6. Forty-five irregular action words

Everyday English Grammar Guide · Spoken English Granny · For Plus Lifetime members

These don't follow the "-ed" rule. Read them aloud: *go, went, gone*.

Base	Past	Done
be	was / were	been
become	became	become
begin	began	begun
bring	brought	brought
build	built	built
buy	bought	bought
catch	caught	caught
choose	chose	chosen
come	came	come
do	did	done
drink	drank	drunk
drive	drove	driven
eat	ate	eaten
fall	fell	fallen
feel	felt	felt
find	found	found
forget	forgot	forgotten
get	got	got
give	gave	given
go	went	gone
have	had	had
hear	heard	heard
keep	kept	kept

Base	Past	Done
know	knew	known
leave	left	left
lose	lost	lost
make	made	made
meet	met	met
pay	paid	paid
read	read	read
run	ran	run
say	said	said
see	saw	seen
sell	sold	sold
send	sent	sent
sit	sat	sat
sleep	slept	slept
speak	spoke	spoken
spend	spent	spent
take	took	taken
teach	taught	taught
tell	told	told
think	thought	thought
understand	understood	understood
write	wrote	written

7. Ready-to-use phrases

Everyday English Grammar Guide · Spoken English Granny · For Plus Lifetime members

Starting a conversation

- Hi, how are you doing?
- It's nice to meet you.
- How was your weekend?
- What do you do?

When you didn't understand

- Sorry, could you say that again?
- Could you speak a little slower, please?
- What do you mean by ...?
- Let me make sure I understood: ...

In an interview

- Thank you for this opportunity.
- I have two years of experience in ...
- One of my strengths is ...
- Could you tell me more about the role?

At work

- I'll get back to you by 5 pm.
- Could we move the meeting to tomorrow?
- I'm working on it right now.
- Please let me know if you need anything else.

Buying things

- How much does this cost?
- Do you have this in a bigger size?
- Can I pay by UPI?
- Is there any discount?

Giving your opinion

- I think ...
- In my opinion, ...
- I agree with you.
- I see your point, but ...

8. Granny's 7 speaking habits

1. **Speak every day**, even for 2 minutes. Little and often beats a lot once a week.
2. **Think in short sentences**. Short and correct is better than long and confusing.
3. **Say it out loud** when you read English: news, captions, menus.
4. **Keep a mistake notebook**. Write each red-pen correction once, by hand.
5. **Copy good speakers**. Pause a video, repeat the sentence, match the rhythm.
6. **Don't translate word by word** from Hindi. Learn whole phrases instead.
7. **Be kind to yourself**. Every mistake Granny circles is progress. Shabash!

Now open Spoken English Granny, pick today's topic, and use one new phrase from this page. 🧐

